

ANAND SHARMA

Commerce and Industry

Commercial Hit | Anand Sharma's stint in the external affairs ministry from 2006-09 is perhaps more famous for the spat with security personnel at the Indira Gandhi International Airport over a privilege that he was not entitled to rather than his spirited defence of the nuclear deal for which he was fielded in Parliament by the UPA. With major dual portfolios, Sharma is out to get something else—incentives to exporters who have suffered in the last few months due to the economic downturn and to give a boost to manufacturing.



YASBANT NEGI

Priorities

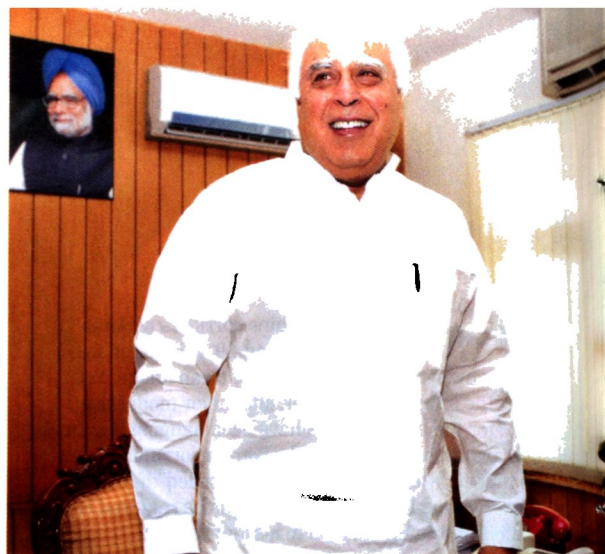
- Bring back growth in manufacturing.
- Boost exports with more measures in the Budget and foreign trade policy in August and aim at a \$200-billion export target.
- Focus on labour-intensive sectors like textiles and leather which are the worst-hit in the meltdown.
- Focus on job losses with incentives to industry that will create employment opportunities.

Is he the one? Kamal Nath may well have stalled negotiations at the WTO to prevent them from going against India but Sharma's erudition on international affairs and diplomatic skills will come in handy while taking the Doha Development Round forward. For a man who drove India's engagement with Africa, walking through a minefield of multilateral agreements could well be a cakewalk.

Personal Quirk

Loves music. When not at work, spends time listening to classical and western music.

▼ 60%



BANDEEP SINGH

KAPIL SIBAL

Human Resource Development

Baggage-Free | Kapil Sibal, 60, easily inhabits two universes. The posh drawing rooms of Delhi which find his sms poetry as intellectually stimulating as his legal arguments and the rough and tumble world of Chandni Chowk. Which is why the St. Stephen's College-Harvard Law School graduate is the best man for a contentious ministry ravaged for 10 years by two men with extreme ideologies. Not to forget his inherited problems: 100 deemed universities of questionable excellence, 15 hastily appointed vice-chancellors of new Central universities and rampant interference in IITs and IIMS.

A. RAJA

Communications and IT

Unlikely Hero | He could have been easily lost in the crowd of family cutouts in Chennai but the Dalit face of the DMK has survived every churn in the party. Raja's was the only name cleared at the first meeting between Sonia Gandhi and M. Karunanidhi and survived 72 hours of brinkmanship and insinuations. An unlikely catalyst, he opened up the sector for competition, drove tariffs to a new low and pushed through number portability.

RAV S. SAHANI

